GROWN-UP'S ANSWER GUIDE

Treasure Island

Robert Louis Stevenson

For grown-ups · spoilers everywhere

READ THIS FIRST: WHERE THESE ANSWERS CAME FROM

Every answer below was checked against the Project Gutenberg text of Treasure Island (ebook #120), read through all 34 chapters. Chapter numbers are given so you can look things up in any edition. Where a question is about opinion, there is no answer key, only a note on what a good answer looks like. If your child's answer disagrees with this sheet, check the book.

The book is the tiebreaker, not this guide. If your reader's answer disagrees with this sheet, assume they're right and check the book.

THE BOOK IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Young Jim Hawkins lives at his parents' inn, the Admiral Benbow, when an old seaman called Billy Bones arrives, hiding from his former shipmates. After Bones dies, Jim and his mother take his sea-chest's hidden packet, which holds a map of the island where the pirate Captain Flint buried his treasure. Squire Trelawney buys the schooner Hispaniola at Bristol and, with Dr. Livesey, takes Captain Smollett as master and Jim as cabin-boy. The ship's cook, Long John Silver, is secretly the leader of a pirate crew, and Jim overhears the plot from inside an apple barrel. On the island the loyal party holds a stockade, Jim meets the marooned Ben Gunn, and then Jim sneaks away, cuts the Hispaniola loose, and takes her back from Israel Hands. Jim is captured by the pirates, but Silver, sensing the plan is failing, protects him and plays both sides. Ben Gunn has already moved the treasure to his cave, so the pirates find an empty pit, and Silver switches to the loyal side once more. The party carries the gold aboard, and at the first port Silver slips away with one bag of coins. Only five of the men who sailed come home.

♡ THE EASIEST CHECK OF ALL

At dinner, ask: "Silver plans to kill the honest men on the ship, and he also protects Jim. Can someone be both? Where does the book want you to land?"

Quest 1 · The Old Sea-Dog

unlocks after a stranger comes tapping up the road to the inn

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

Three opinion questions about the old captain, and a drawing of him using only clues from the text.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 1: The captain promises Jim "a silver fourpenny on the first of every month" to keep a "weather-eye open for a seafaring man with one leg." Jim says he paid "pretty dear" for it in nightmares.
2. Ch. 1: Dr. Livesey "never so much as moved" and spoke "perfectly calm and steady" while the captain held an open knife. He told him to put it away or he'd "hang at the next assizes."
3. Ch. 1: The neighbours join in "for dear life, with the fear of death upon them," each singing louder than the next "to avoid remark."
4. Drawing clues (Ch. 1): tall, strong, heavy, nut-brown; tarry pigtail; soiled blue coat; sabre cut across one cheek; brass telescope; sea-chest.

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Any opinion backed by something from the book. For the drawing, anything that shows at least three of the clues above (scar, pigtail, telescope, coat). Stick figures are fine.

Quest 2 · The Captain's Chest

unlocks after an oilskin packet is opened

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

Two opinion questions, a drawing of the island from Jim's description of the map, and a sealed prediction to open at the end.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 4: Jim's mother says, "I'll have my dues, and not a farthing over," and keeps counting even when Jim urges her to run.
2. Ch. 6: Dr. Livesey says the one man he's afraid of is the squire, "for you cannot hold your tongue."
3. Map details (Ch. 6): about nine miles long and five across; "shaped, you might say, like a fat dragon standing up"; two fine land-locked harbours; a hill in the centre marked "The Spy-glass"; three red crosses, two on the north part and one in the southwest, with the words "Bulk of treasure here" next to the last.

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Opinion questions: any argument with a reason from the chapter. Drawing: should show a dragon-like shape, a central hill, two harbours and three crosses. Sealed prediction: any real guess; it is opened in Quest 10.

Quest 3 · All Aboard in Bristol

unlocks after the schooner is loaded and ready

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

A crossword about names and things from Bristol, and one opinion question about Silver.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 8: Silver shouts for his men to catch Black Dog because he "hasn't paid his score," then laughs "until the tears ran down his cheeks" about forgetting the bill. Jim says he "would have gone bail for the innocence of Long John Silver."
2. Crossword context, Ch. 9: Smollett says, "I don't like this cruise; I don't like the men; and I don't like my officer," and asks that the powder and arms be kept under the cabin and the map stay secret.

CROSSWORD ANSWERS

Across: 1. SCHOONER, 3. BRISTOL, 5. HISPANIOLA, 7. BLACKDOG, 8. REDRUTH, 9. TRELAWNEY
Down: 2. CRUTCH, 3. BLANDLY, 4. SPYGLASS, 6. SMOLLETT

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A reason from the text, not just yes or no. A strong answer notices that Silver's big show is exactly what made Jim trust him.

Quest 4 · The Apple Barrel

unlocks after the island comes into view

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

Four character cards, and two questions the child writes for you.

ANSWERS

1. Silver: Ch. 10 he cooks, sings, keeps a parrot named Captain Flint, and is called Barbecue; Ch. 11 he plots in the apple barrel; Ch. 12 he says he has watered at the island and names its hills.
2. Smollett: Ch. 9 spots the danger first; Ch. 10 "thoroughly understood his business" as captain.
3. Trelawney: Ch. 10 "had followed the sea" and stands watches; Ch. 12 admits "you were right, and I was wrong" to the captain.
4. Livesey: Ch. 12 hears Jim's warning and says, "Thank you, Jim," loudly, "that was all I wanted to know," so no one suspects. The loyal party is seven of twenty-six, one of them a boy.

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

For the cards, any answer that matches something from Ch. 10-12. For the stump-the-grown-up questions, the child checks your answers against the book.

Quest 5 · Jim Goes Ashore

unlocks after a cannon shot echoes across the island

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

A six-panel comic about the shore adventure, plus one question about Ben Gunn's food.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 13: Jim slips into a boat and curls up in the "fore-sheets." The captain had suggested the afternoon ashore on purpose.
2. Ch. 15: Ben Gunn, "marooned three years agone," has lived on "goats since then, and berries, and oysters" and dreams of cheese, "toasted, mostly."

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Comic: one clear scene with at least two speech bubbles and a sound effect, using a real event from the chapters. Question: any food, with a reason.

Quest 6 · A Boat Too Full

unlocks after the first day of fighting ends

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

Invent one item for the people stuck at the stockade, with a recipe and an item card.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 17: the overloaded jolly-boat (five grown men plus powder, pork and bread) sinks "quite gently, in three feet of water." No lives are lost, but only two of five guns still work and they leave "a good half of all our powder and provisions" behind.
2. Ch. 16: the doctor likes the stockade because of its spring; the ship's cabin was well supplied, but "we had no water."

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Strong answers solve a problem from the chapters (food, water, powder, guns, getting ashore dry). Reward silly ideas that still make sense in the story.

Quest 7 · The Stockade

unlocks after the first real attack on the stockade

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

Two opinion questions, a captain's-log entry, and two truths and a lie.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 18: The squire thinks the flag is a target; the captain cries "Strike my colours!" and answers, "No, sir, not I." The doctor says it was "good policy besides" because it "showed our enemies that we despised their cannonade."
2. Ch. 20: Silver climbs the fence and the knoll on his crutch, says the men "have chosen me cap'n," and asks for the chart. He offers either a ride to safety once the treasure is aboard or a split of the stores. Smollett refuses, so Silver spits in the spring and leaves.
3. Log format (Ch. 18): names and ranks, what happened, the loss of Redruth. A good entry has who came, what he wanted, and what the captain answered.

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Opinion questions: a stated reason. The log should sound like a captain: plain and factual. For two truths and a lie, check that two statements are really in Ch. 19-21.

Quest 8 · Jim's Sea Adventure

unlocks after the Hispaniola touches the sand

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

A coracle drawing, two opinion questions, and a note Jim should have left.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 22: the coracle is a "rude, lop-sided framework of tough wood" covered with goat-skin, hair inside, with "one thwart set as low as possible," "a kind of stretcher in the bows," and "a double paddle." Jim calls it "the first and the worst coracle ever made by man," but "exceedingly light and portable."
2. Ch. 22: Jim calls the escape "foolish" and "my second folly," but also that it was "a help towards saving all of us."
3. Ch. 25: Jim tells Hands, "you'll please regard me as your captain until further notice."

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Drawing: should show a round, small boat with a skin cover, a seat and a double paddle. Note: should say where Jim is going and why, and ideally admit it was risky.

Quest 9 · Pieces of Eight

unlocks after a visitor calls at dawn

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

A take-a-side argument on Silver, and a short answer on Jim's promise.

ANSWERS

1. For "villain": he plans to kill the loyal crew (Ch. 11) and kills an honest sailor named Tom (Ch. 14). For "complicated": in Ch. 28-29 he stops his men from hurting Jim, and tells the doctor he has "the shakes upon me for the gallows" (Ch. 30).
2. More evidence, Ch. 29: when his crew tries to depose him, Silver blames his crew for the failed cruise, reminds them the doctor keeps them healthy and a ship is coming, throws down the chart, then resigns so they beg him to stay ("Barbecue forever!").
3. Ch. 30: the doctor says, "Jump! One jump, and you're out," but Jim answers, "Silver trusted me; I passed my word, and back I go."

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

No right side. A strong answer names a real event from the book on each side and admits the other side has a fair point.

Quest 10 · The Treasure Hunt

unlocks when you finish the book

THE PAGE ASKS FOR

Open the Quest 2 prediction, one question on the voice in the trees, a postcard from Silver, and a rating.

ANSWERS

1. Ch. 32: Silver argues that a spirit wouldn't have "an echo," and soon the pirates recognise the voice as Ben Gunn's. Ch. 33 confirms it: Ben Gunn worked "upon the superstitions of his former shipmates."
2. Ch. 32: the pit holds a broken pick-shaft and boards branded WALRUS. Ch. 33: Ben Gunn had dug up the treasure and moved it to his cave about two months before the Hispaniola arrived.
3. Ch. 34: Silver sneaks off the ship in a shore boat with one sack of coin, "worth perhaps three or four hundred guineas." Jim guesses he found his wife and the parrot.

NO SINGLE RIGHT ANSWER: WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Prediction: any honest scoring. Postcard: should sound like Silver (confident and flattering, with sea-words such as "shiver my timbers" and "you may lay to that").